SECRET:

Japan's future relations with China.

FLAG A. The background is explained in the brief prepared ten days ago for the Secretary of State's talks in Paris with Mr. Acheson.

FLAG B. Mr. Ringwalt, U.S. Embassy, called on Mr. R.H. Scott to-day and left the attached letter. He explained that the proposal was that Mr. Merchant, who is acting in place of Mr. Rusk as Assistant Secretary of State dealing with the Far East, should come to London, arriving tomorrow, in order to discuss the question of Japan's relations with the Chinese Nationalists; the urgency of his visit being due to the fact that Mr. R.H. Scott leaves for the Bukit Serene Conference at the end of this week. Mr. Ringwalt said that the proposal, together with the telegram from Mr. Dulles quoted in Mr. Ringwalt's letter, had been shown to the Secretary of State in Paris and that the Secretary of State had agreed to the visit. ~~(Mr. R.H. Scott has had a telephone message from Mr. Shuckburgh to the same effect).~~

The arrangement agreed with Mr.Ringwalt is that he and Mr. Merchant would come and discuss the question with Mr. R.H. Scott at 3 p.m. tomorrow November 13th.

In explanation of the first paragraph of Mr. Dulles's telegram, quoted in Mr. Ringwalt's letter, I should add that Mr. Yoshida has indicated in the Diet that Japan will go extremely cautiously about establishing formal relations with the Chinese Nationalists. This is evidently what has upset Mr. Dulles and the Republican Senators who have been concerned with the Japanese Peace Treaty.

FLAG D. I attach in draft form some notes of points which might be made to Mr.Merchant. As time is short, I should be very grateful for any comments on them by 12 noon tomorrow.

C.H. Johnston.

(C.H. Johnston)
12th November,1951.

Copies sent to:

Mr. Fitzmaurice;—
China & Korea Dept.
U.N. (Pol) Department.
American Department.

I think para 8 of the notes should be omitted. This para misconceives the US argument

NOTHING TO BE WRITTEN IN THIS MARGIN.

(27269) Wt. 22832—217 350m 11/50 G.S.&S.

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